

Linxi Lu
Curriculum Vitae

Harris School of Public Policy &
Committee on Education
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EDUCATION

- Ph.D. Applied Developmental and Educational Psychology, Boston College, MA, 2024
Dissertation: *Understanding and Advancing the Home Math Environment*
Committee: Marina Vasilyeva (chair), Elida V. Laski, Eric Dearing, Sara Cordes
M.S. Applied Developmental and Educational Psychology, Boston College, MA, 2021
M.E. Human Development and Psychology, Harvard University, MA, 2018
B.A. Economics, Washington University in St. Louis, MO, 2016

EMPLOYMENT

- 2024 - 2027 Postdoctoral Scholar, Committee on Education & Harris School of Public Policy
University of Chicago

AWARDS

- 2026 Early Education & Child Development Dissertation Award, American Educational Research Association (*AERA*, *EE/CD SIG*)
2025 Biennial Outstanding Doctoral Dissertation Award, Society of Research in Child Development (*SRCD*)
2024 Outstanding Dissertation Award (Human Development), American Educational Research Association (*AERA*, Division E)
2024 Apprenticeship in College Teaching (ACT) Certificate, Boston College
2022 The Donald J. White Teaching Excellence Award, Boston College

FELLOWSHIPS AND GRANTS

- 2026 - 2027 Early Childhood Education and Play Pilot Grant (\$47,995), Caplan Foundation for Early Childhood, Co-PI
2025 - 2026 Successful Pathways from School to Work Research Grant (\$10,000), the Hymen Milgrom Supporting Organization, PI
2025 - 2026 Social Policy Research Initiative Pilot Grant (\$76,498), The Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL), Co-PI

- 2024 - 2027 Committee on Education Postdoctoral Scholarship (\$240,000), University of Chicago
- 2023 - 2024 Next Generation of Family Math Researchers Dissertation Fellow (\$10,000), National Association for Family, School and Community Engagement
- 2023 Summer Dissertation Development Grant (\$2,500), Lynch School of Education and Human Development, Boston College
- 2023 Conference, Research, and Professional Development Grant (\$500), Boston College
- 2022, 2023 Doctoral Student Travel Grants (\$500), Boston College

GRANTS INVOLVED

- 2025-2026 Chat2Learn Suite, From Seedlings to Scale Grants Program, Institute of Education Sciences, R305J250039
- 2021-2024 Recruiting Spatial-Numerical Representations to Enhance the Use of Advanced Math Strategies in Low-Income Students, Institute of Education Sciences, R305A200315

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-reviewed journal articles

1. **Lu L.**, Vasilyeva M., & Laski E. (2025) Navigating Trade-offs in Early Math: How Informational Priming Influences Parent-Child Interaction. *Child Development*. Online Advanced Access <http://doi.org/10.1111/cdev.70031>
2. **Lu, L.**, Vasilyeva, M., & Laski, E. V., (2025) Home math environment as a mediator of socioeconomic differences in early math skills: A study of Chinese families from disparate backgrounds. *Developmental Psychology*, 61(3), 417–431. <https://doi.org/10.1037/dev0001918>
3. **Lu L.**, Vasilyeva M., Laski E. (2025), Spontaneous Focus on Numerosity in Parents of Preschoolers: Is It Related to Actual Math Input Parents Provide? *Journal of Experimental Child Psychology*. 250, 1061212008 <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jecp.2024.106121>
4. Vasilyeva, M., **Lu, L.**, Damoah, K., & Laski, E. V. (2025). Compensatory Relation Between Executive Function and Fluid Intelligence in Predicting Math Learning. *Education Sciences*, 15(7), 790. <https://doi.org/10.3390/educsci15070790>
5. Vasilyeva, M., Rey-Guerra, C., **Lu, L.**, & Dearing, E. (2025), Parental input as a mediating pathway for gender differences in early academic skills. *Early Childhood Research Quarterly*, 72, 35-43. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ecresq.2025.02.002>
6. Vasilyeva, M., Laski, E. V., Casey, B., Konstantopoulos, S., **Lu, L.**, Ban, J., Betar, S., Cho, H. Y., & Wang, M. (2025), Recruiting spatial-numerical representations to increase

arithmetic fluency in low-income students. *Developmental Psychology*, 61 (6), 1152–1165. <https://doi.org/10.1037/dev0001921>

7. **Lu, L.**, Vasilyeva, M., & Laski, E. V. (2023), Minor changes, big differences? Effects of manipulating play materials on parental math talk. *Developmental Psychology*, 59(7), 1283–1299. <https://doi.org/10.1037/dev0001550>

8. Vasilyeva M., Laski E.V., Casey B.M., **Lu L.**, Wang M., Cho H.Y. (2023), Spatial–Numerical Magnitude Estimation Mediates Early Sex Differences in the Use of Advanced Arithmetic Strategies. *Journal of Intelligence*. 11(5):97. <https://doi.org/10.3390/jintelligence11050097>

9. Dearing, E., Casey, B., Davis-Kean, P.E., Eason, S., Gunderson, E., Levine, S.C., Laski, E.V., Libertus, M., **Lu, L.**, Lombardi, C.M. and Nelson, A. (2022), Socioeconomic Variations in The Frequency of Parent Number Talk: A Meta-Analysis. *Education Sciences*, 12(5), 312. <https://doi.org/10.3390/educsci12050312>

10. Traube, D. E., Hsiao, H. Y., Rau, A., Hunt-O’Brien, D., **Lu, L.**, & Islam, N. (2020), Advancing home-based parenting programs through the use of telehealth technology. *Journal of Child and Family Studies*, 29(1), 44-53. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10826-019-01458-w>

Peer-reviewed books and book chapters

11. **Lu, L.** (2020), *Introspection (自言自语)*. P.R.China, Huazhang Psychology Press.

12. Morelli, G., & **Lu, L.** (2021), Pluralities and Commonalities in Children’s Relationships. *Attachment: The Fundamental Questions*, 237-243.

Invited Commentary and Research Brief

1. Kalil A., **Lu, L.**, Sarrazin E. (2026). The Promise of LLMs for Measuring Parent–Child Interaction: What We Know and What We Need to Know. *The Learning Agency* (The Cutting Ed).

2. **Lu, L.** (2025). Understanding and Advancing the Home Math Environment: Socioeconomic Disparities and Intervention Opportunities. *Center for Family Math*

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

[†] Denotes equal contributions. [°] Denotes mentee author

Lu L., Vasilyeva M., [°]Zhang Y. & [°]Zhang N., More Math Talk, Less Engagement? The Mediating Role of Negative, Non-process Based Feedback. *Developmental Psychology*

Lu L., [°]Zhang Y., [°]Zhang N., & Barger M. How Parental Math Anxiety Shapes Parent–Child Math Interactions: Evidence From Strategy Use, Autonomy Support, and Feedback. *Journal of Educational Psychology*

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPERATION

[†] Denotes equal contributions. [°] Denotes mentee author

Lu L. & Kalil A., Reducing Parental Cognitive Barriers to Promote Early Language Development: A Randomized Evaluation of Chat2Learn Among Low-Income Families. *Child Development*

Lu L., & Kalil A., Parent-Child Hypothetical Talk in Early Childhood: Variation in Contingency, Elaborative Scaffolding, and Children's Conversational Responses. *Journal of Applied Developmental Psychology*

Lu L.[†], Vasilyeva M.[†] & Levine S. C., Time to Think: Temporal Constraints, Cognitive Reflection, and Whole-Number Bias in Young Adults, *Journal of Cognitive Psychology*

[†]**Lu L.** & [†]Kalil A., Just Do It: The Importance of Habit Formation in Shifting Parents' Investments in Child Skills. *Psychological Review*

Lu L., Kalil A., Mayer S. E., & Goldin-Meadow S., Math Teaching Apps Can Level the Playing Field by Decreasing the Performance for High Education Home. *PNAS*

Lu L., Leyva D., & Libertus M., The Compensatory Relation Between Parental Math Talk and Autonomy Support in a Longitudinal Intervention. *Educational Sciences*

° Ito S. & **Lu L.**, Understanding the Multifaceted Nature of Math Gender Stereotype Among Parents of Preschoolers, *Frontiers in Psychology*

°[†]Buriani R., Levine S.C., & [†]**Lu L.**, Gender Differences in Arithmetic Strategies Proposed to Children in Parent-Child Interactions, *Journal of Numerical Cognition*

Sarrazin E., **Lu L.**, Kalil A., Large Language Model-Based Coding of Child Creativity: Scale Development and Validation

[†]Wu X. & [†]**Lu L.**, From Home to School: A Teacher-Partnered Intervention to Strengthen Preschoolers' Counting, Subitizing, and Base-Ten Knowledge

INVITED TALKS

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| 2027 | The Promise of LLMs for Measuring Parent-Child Interaction: What We Know and What We Need to Know, University of Chicago Center in Paris, June 1 st |
| 2026 | Rethinking Early Learning in Changing Contexts, The Education University of Hong Kong, August 6 th |
| 2026 | Talk as Capital, University of Washington Seattle, February 20 th |
| 2025 | Beyond the Knowledge Gap: Rethinking How Families Support Early Learning in Diverse Contexts, Tufts University, November 24 th . |
| 2024 | Understanding and Advancing Home Math Environment, Rutgers University, New Brunswick, July 8 th . |
| 2024 | Interplay of Sociocultural and Cognitive Processes in Early Math Development, |

Indiana University Bloomington, March 4th.

2024 Socioeconomic Disparities and Intervention Opportunities in Early Math Development, Zhejiang University, China, April 17th.

CONFERENCE ACTIVITY

Symposia Organized

- 2026 Math for Real Life: Rethinking Curriculum and Intervention Through Everyday Mathematical Reasoning, MCLS Annual Meeting, Padua, Italy, June 23-25
- 2026 Promoting Family-school Engagement, Roundtable Session Chair & Discussant, AERA Annual Meeting, Los Angeles, CA, USA, April 8-12
- 2026 Youth and Advancing Family-School Partnerships, Roundtable Session Chair & Discussant, AERA Annual Meeting, Los Angeles, CA, USA, April 8-12
- 2025 Family Engagement and Digital Interventions in Early Math Development: Insights from Diverse and Underrepresented Populations, SRCD Biennial Meeting, Minneapolis, MN, USA, May 1-3.
- 2025 Understanding the Multifaceted Nature of Parent-Child Math Interaction, the Mathematical Cognition and Learning Society Meeting, Hong Kong, June 9-11.

Papers

[°] Denotes mentee.

- 2026 **Lu L.**, Vasilyeva M., Levine S., Whole-number bias and the limits of everyday proportional reasoning in young adults, MCLS Annual Meeting, Padua, Italy, June 23-25
- 2026 Saya I., **Lu L.**, Understanding the Multifaceted Nature of Math Gender Stereotype Among Chinese Parents of Preschoolers, MCLS Annual Meeting, Padua, Italy, June 23-25
- 2026 **Lu L.**, [°]Zhang Y., [°]Zhang N., More Math Talk, Less Engagement? The Mediating Role of Negative Feedback in Parent-Child Math Interactions, AERA Annual Meeting, Los Angeles, CA, USA, April 8-12
- 2025 **Lu L.**, Vasilyeva M., Laski E. V., Navigating Trade-offs in Early Math: How Context Influences Parent-Child Interaction, The Mathematical Cognition and Learning Society Meeting, Hong Kong, China, June 9-11.
- 2025 **Lu L.**, Kalil A., Mayer S. E., Liu H., Context Matters: Parent-Child Interactions During Digital App and Analog Toys Guided Play Activities, SRCD Biennial Meeting, Minneapolis, MN, USA, May 1-3.
- 2024 **Lu, L.**, Vasilyeva M., Laski E., & [°]Chen, N. H., Spontaneous Focus on Numerosity in Parents of Preschoolers: Is it Related to the Math Input They Provide? The Mathematical Cognition and Learning Society Meeting, Washington, DC, USA, June 26-28.

- 2024 **Lu, L.,** Vasilyeva M., Laski E., & Chen N. H., Socioeconomic Status, Home Math Environment, and Early Math Development: Commonalities and Differences Across Groups. The Mathematical Cognition and Learning Society Meeting, Washington, DC, USA, June 26-28.
- 2023 **Lu, L.,** Vasilyeva M., & Laski E., Long-term Effects of Manipulating Play Materials and Game Contexts on Parent-Child Math Talk AERA Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL, USA, April 13-16.
- 2023 **Lu, L.,** Vasilyeva M., & Laski E. Minor Changes, Big Differences? Effects of Manipulating Play Materials on Parental Math Talk, SRCD Biennial Meeting, Salt Lake City, Utah, USA, March 22-26.
- 2023 Vasilyeva M., Laski E., Casey B., **Lu L.,** Wang M., Cho H. Y., Number Sense Mediates Sex Differences in the Use of Advanced Arithmetic Strategies, SRCD Biennial Meeting, Salt Lake City, Utah, USA, March 22-26.

Posters

- 2023 **Lu, L. &** Vasilyeva M., Investigating Socio-Economic, Cognitive, and Motivational Factors Associated with Parental Math Talk SRCD Biennial Meeting, Salt Lake City, Utah, USA, March 22-26.

CAMPUS TALKS

- 2025 Navigating Trade-offs in Early Math: How Context Influences Parent-Child Interaction, Committee on Education Workshop, University of Chicago
- 2025 Informational Priming and Parent-child Math Interaction, Departments of Psychology and Comparative Human Development, University of Chicago
- 2022 Features of Toy Material and Parental-Child Play, Department of Psychology, Boston College
- 2022 Implicit Manipulation to Increase Parental Math Talk, Lynch School of Education and Human Development, Boston College

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Boston College, Instructor

Cognition and Learning (fall 2023)
Child Growth and Development (spring 2022, fall 2021)

Boston College, Teaching Assistant

Family, School, and Society (spring 2021, spring 2020, spring 2024)
Advanced Practicum (spring 2021)
Applied Child Development (fall 2019, spring 2020)

Public Online Course, Instructor

Child Development and Parenting (fall, 2022)

Emotion Regulation and Interpersonal Relationships (fall, 2019)
How People Learn (fall 2018)

MENTORING

° Denotes mentorship for Bachelor of Philosophy Honors Thesis and/or Psychology Honors Thesis

† Denotes mentorship for Master's Thesis. *Denotes Best Thesis Award

‡ Denotes mentorship for Ph.D. Student

Johannes Gutenberg University Mainz

‡Erik Sarrazin (Spring 2026 – Current)

University of Chicago

*‡ Saya Ito (Fall 2025- Current)

† Raquel Buriani (Spring 2026 – Current)

Ashton Mayo-Beavers (Fall 2024 - Current)

Annette Mehta (Summer 2025)

Janiya Brown (Summer 2025)

Allison Yu (Spring 2025)

Anna Hattchikian (Spring 2025)

Yazeed Abayazid (Fall, 2024)

Cyrus Hannallah (Summer - Fall 2024)

Lily Suskind (Summer 2024)

Boston College

‡ Karla Mercedes (Fall 2025 – Current)

‡ Kennedy Damoah (Fall 2024 – Current)

‡ Yilin Liu (Fall 2023 – Spring 2024)

° Nanyu Zhang (Fall 2023 – Current)

° Yiling Zhang (Fall 2023 – Current)

Rui Zhu (Summer 2023 – Spring 2024)

Huangliang Chen (Summer 2021 - Spring 2023)

Hehua Xu (Summer 2021 – Spring 2023)

May Chen (Summer 2021 – Spring 2023)

Yiwen Zhang (Summer 2021 – Spring 2023)

Columbia University

Haoyu Chen (Summer 2023 – Fall 2024)

New York University- Shanghai

Yuchen Bao (Summer 2021 – Spring 2023)

Zhejiang University

Hongyi Shen (Fall 2024 – Current)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2019-2024 Graduate Research Assistant, Boston College, the Thinking and Learning Lab
Led research efforts on a four-year longitudinal intervention exploring how spatial-numerical training can support advanced math strategy development in low-income elementary students (Institute of Educational Sciences; \$1,400,000).

2018-2019 Researcher, Parents as Teachers & USC School of Social Work
Analyzed and compared the intervention outcomes between a virtual and an on-ground home-visiting program (Parents as Teachers & USC Telehealth Project). Investigated how the change of implementation tool would impact the quality of the sessions and parent-educator relationship

2017-2018 Graduate Research Assistant, Harvard University, the Snow Lab

Designed a bi-lingual curriculum (Mandarin & Uigur) for preschool Uygur children and co-designed a picture book-based mandarin curriculum for Chinese rural young children, which was implemented in the One Village One Preschool program in Gui Zhou province.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Peer Review

Consulting Editor, Child Development, 2026

Journal Editor (Special Issue), Journal of Intelligence, 2025

Journal Reviewer, Child Development, 2026

Journal Reviewer, Brain Science and Child Development, 2026

Journal Reviewer, Discover Education, 2026

Journal Reviewer, Humanities and Social Sciences Communications, 2026

Journal Reviewer, Learning and Individual Differences, 2025

Journal Reviewer, Frontiers in Psychology, 2025

Journal Reviewer, International Journal of Early Years Education, 2025

Journal Reviewer, Nature Reviews Psychology, 2025

Journal Reviewer, Journal of Educational Psychology, 2025

Journal Reviewer, Journal of Numerical Cognition, 2025

Journal Reviewer, Developmental Psychology, 2025

Journal Reviewer, British Journal of Developmental Psychology, 2024 - 2025

Journal Reviewer, Mathematical Thinking and Learning, 2024 - 2025

Journal Reviewer, Early Human Development, 2024 - 2025

Symposium Reviewer, SRCD Biennial Meeting, Minneapolis, MN, 2025

Symposium Reviewer, AERA Annual Meeting, Denver, CO, 2025

Symposium Reviewer, AERA Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA, 2024

To University

Postdoc Advisory Board, University of Chicago, 2025 - 2025

Committee on Education, University of Chicago, 2024 - 2026

Diversity Committee, Applied Developmental and Educational Psychology, Boston College, 2022 - 2023

Student Services Council, Applied Developmental and Educational Psychology, Boston College, 2023 - 2024

OTHER PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Program Founder, Parent Matters: the Growing Star Parent-Child Program, Sandoor Education Research Center, HangZhou, Zhejiang, China, 2008 - 2024

Family Engagement and Educational Psychology Consultant, Xianghu Future School, Hangzhou, Zhejiang, China, 2023 - 2024

Guest Broadcast Commentator, Beijing, China, 2018 - 2019

Freelance Writer, 2012 - Current

PROFESSIONAL ASSOCIATIONS

Society of Research in Child Development, 2019 - present

American Educational Research Association, 2019 - present

The Mathematical Cognition and Learning Society, 2023 - present

LANGUAGES

English: Advanced reading, writing, speaking

Chinese: Native reading, writing, speaking

German: Intermediate reading, writing, speaking

Korean: Beginner speaking